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A STRAIGHT ANSWER FOR LUXURY HOMEOWNERS

Why Didn't It *Sell*?



The five honest reasons luxury homes in Placer, Sacramento, and El Dorado Counties come off the market without an offer, and what I would do differently the second time.

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This is not intended as a solicitation if your property is currently listed with another broker or if you are currently working with a licensed real estate professional.

Why didn't it sell?

Your home came off the market, and you are probably hearing from a lot of agents right now. This is simply what I see when a home over \$1M in Placer, Sacramento, or El Dorado County doesn't sell. It is almost never the house. It is one or more of these five things.

1 It was priced on hope, not on closed sales

Somebody looked at what the neighbors were asking and added a little. Buyers at this level don't shop that way. They compare your home to the three closest closed sales, and they can see the gap from their phone. An overpriced luxury home here doesn't get low offers. It gets quiet.

What I would do instead: my team and I run the number ourselves from the last 90 days of closed sales in your area. No algorithm, no wishful thinking, and I show you the three homes a buyer will compare yours to.

2 The first six photos lost the showing

A buyer decides whether to drive out to Granite Bay or El Dorado Hills from the first six pictures. If the front elevation was shot at noon with a flat sky, the rooms were dark, and there was no twilight, no drone, and no video, you lost tours you never knew about.

What I would do instead: twilight photography, drone, a video walk-through, floor plans, and virtual staging for any empty room. On a home like yours that is the floor, not the ceiling.

3 It only reached buyers who were already looking

The MLS, a sign, and the big portals have enormous reach, but they only reach people who are already searching, and mostly the ones searching nearby. The buyer for a home like yours is often not searching yet. IRS migration data shows the people moving into our region come from the Bay Area, Los Angeles, San Diego, Phoenix, and Reno, and many of them have not yet realized that a home with land, oaks, and a lake view is within reach. If your listing was never put in front of them, they never knew it existed.

What I would do instead: marketing that reaches buyers before they start searching: advertising placed in {METROS} in front of people researching a move to the Sacramento region, retargeting to everyone who views the home, the eXp Luxury network and global portals, and direct outreach to the relocation agents who bring those buyers to the foothills.

4 Buyers judged the house, not the home

At this price buyers expect finished. A dated fixture, a deferred repair, an empty room, or too much of your own life on the counters makes a buyer quietly discount the home before they ever write an offer. They don't pay for potential. They pay for done.

What I would do instead: a 45-minute walk-through with you, room by room, to decide what to stage, what to update, and what to leave alone. Then a pre-inspection so nothing surprises us in escrow.

5 The listing went quiet after week two

The launch was the whole plan. When the first wave of showings slowed, nothing changed: same photos, same reach, same price, and the days-on-market counter kept climbing while every buyer watched. A luxury sale is managed every week, with decisions built in ahead of time, or it just runs out the clock.

What I would do instead: a written plan, agreed before we launch, for what we review at weeks two, four, and eight and what can change. And a standing update from me with showings, feedback, and the next move. You will never wonder what is going on with your home.

How I would relaunch it

1. **The walk-through.** Forty-five minutes at the house, no pressure, so I can see it the way a buyer will.
2. **The number.** A valuation my team and I build from closed luxury sales, not asking prices. I'll send it to you in writing.
3. **The reset.** New photography, video, drone, floor plans, staging where it matters, and a pre-inspection.
4. **The launch.** A date we choose, pre-marketing to my buyer and agent list first, then ads where the buyers come from.
5. **The standing update.** From me, until it closes.



I have never relisted a home with the same photos and a lower price and called it a strategy. If that's the only idea an agent brings you, keep interviewing.

— CINDY

A little about me: I'm a luxury listing specialist with eXp Luxury, and I ran businesses before real estate, which is why my plan is always in writing. My team and I work Placer, Sacramento, and El Dorado Counties, from Granite Bay and El Dorado Hills to Loomis, Auburn, Folsom, and East Sacramento, and homes that didn't sell the first time are a big part of what we do. You will get a straight answer from me, in writing, before you sign anything.

You don't need another agent telling you what you want to hear. You need a real number and a real plan.

Before you pick anyone, do two things. Get your home's value from closed sales, not from a website guess. Then ask every agent who calls you for their plan in writing. If they can't put it on paper, that tells you something. Mine is on the pages you just read, and I'm happy to walk you through it at your kitchen table.

NEXT STEP

Start with a real number for *your* home.



SCAN FOR YOUR
HOME VALUE FROM
CLOSED SALES

Scan the code for a home value report built on closed luxury sales in your neighborhood. Then, if you want, we'll walk the home together. No pressure and no pitch.

Call or text 805-478-1412

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Book a time calendly.com/realcindylitz

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